

Reading Practice

The impact of social media in young people

In recent years, social media has become one of the most powerful tools in modern life. Platforms like Instagram, TikTok, and X allow people to share ideas, stay informed, and communicate instantly with others all around the world. For many young people, checking their social media accounts is part of their daily routine — almost as natural as eating or sleeping.

However, experts have noticed both positive and negative effects of this habit. On the positive side, social media helps students connect with classmates, learn new skills, and express creativity through videos, photos, or writing. It also allows them to stay updated on global events and discover opportunities for study, art, or work.

On the other hand, spending too much time online can create stress, anxiety, and low self-esteem. Constant comparison with others can make people feel inadequate or unhappy with their own lives. Many young users admit they sometimes feel pressure to appear “perfect” online. Studies have shown that reducing screen time and focusing on real-life activities improves emotional health and social relationships.

Teachers and parents are now trying to help students use technology responsibly. They encourage them to take short breaks, set time limits, and use social media for learning instead of just entertainment. Finding balance is the key — using technology to improve life, not to control it.

Answer the questions

1. What are some positive effects of social media mentioned.
2. What negative effects can too much social media use cause?
3. Why do some young users feel pressure online?
4. What did studies show about reducing screen time?
5. What are teachers and parents doing to help students?
6. What does the writer mean by “finding balance”?
7. Find one verb in past tense from the text.
8. Find one adjective that describes an emotion.
9. What is the main idea of the text?
10. What do you personally think about social media — is it more positive or negative?